

VENTURA COUNTY, CA · 34°16′N 119°14′W

California Fractional HR

COMPLIANCE-FIRST · STATEWIDE

The CHRO Retainer — *Overview*

Senior, compliance-first HR leadership for companies of 20 to 100 employees — the judgment of a Chief HR Officer, without the full-time hire.

see where you stand → reach safe ground → build the system → chart forward

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THE CHRO RETAINER — OVERVIEW

Contents

A standing CHRO retainer — the offer, the frameworks it installs, the rhythm behind it, and where it sits in the method. Four pages, in order.

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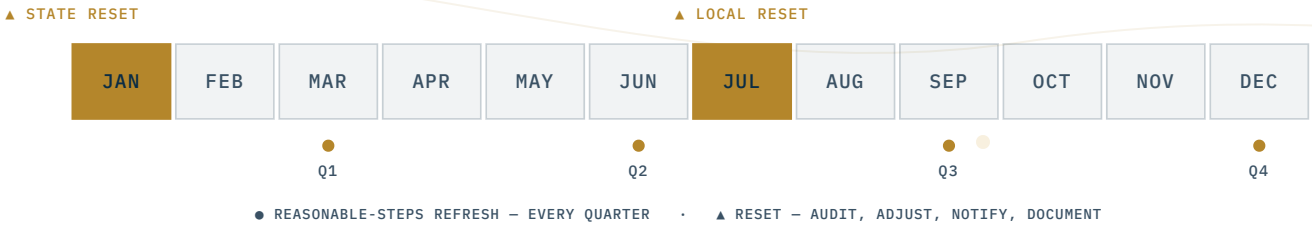
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Your managers run the routine— *we keep the risk, the reset & the record.*

A standing retainer that installs the frameworks your managers run — coaching, documentation, escalation — and keeps the compliance machine current on California's calendar. Your team handles the day-to-day; the risk events, the twice-yearly reset, and the provable record stay with us.

THE RHYTHM UNDERNEATH · TWELVE MONTHS, TWO RESETS, FOUR REFRESHES

The cadence your managers run on — kept current, so nothing slips



Every January 1 minimum-wage step silently re-prices the exempt-salary floor (2× minimum wage — $70,304 in 2026); salaries left unadjusted reclassify on their own. The machine audits in December — before the reset, not after.

The CHRO Retainer

$3,500/mo retainer

20 executive hours a month of CHRO-level work. The core of the engagement — the frameworks installed, the risk retained, the record kept.

VENTURA · SANTA BARBARA · STATEWIDE VIRTUAL

WHAT IT DELIVERS

- → The compliance calendar refresh — kept current on California's Jan/July cycle
- → The playbooks, installed — team building, GROW coaching, SBI documentation, the escalation triggers
- → The risk seat, retained — real risk events route to the CHRO, not your managers
- → A monthly one-page note — delivered, decided, prevented

Start the engine. *Tell me your headcount — a scoped operating cadence back within one business day.*

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The reset, in *plain English.*

Twice a year California rewrites the numbers underneath your payroll — which is why compliance is a subscription, not an event, and why the calendar is the product.

WHY IT NEVER SETTLES

Past twenty employees, compliance stops being a project and becomes permanent, recurring work. Twice a year the state resets wages, thresholds, and statutes — and every reset ripples into postings, payroll, exemptions, and the handbook. A machine turns that reset into one scheduled motion: audit, adjust, notify, document.

JANUARY 1

THE STATE RESET · WAGES, THRESHOLDS, NEW LAW

WAGES	The statewide minimum wage steps up — $16.90/hr as of January 1, 2026 — and dozens of local rates sit above it.
THRESHOLDS	The exempt-salary floor is 2× minimum wage — $70,304/yr in 2026. A raise to one silently moves the other.
NEW LAW	Each year's statutes take effect — postings, wage notices, payroll systems, and handbook provisions all update.
THE TRAP	An exempt salary left alone in December is a misclassification in January — audit before the reset, not after.

JULY 1

THE LOCAL RESET · CITIES & INDUSTRIES

WAGES	Local minimum-wage increases land in many cities; healthcare and industry rates step up on their own schedules.
THE RULE	Pay the highest rate applicable to where the work is performed — remote employees included; a few hours a week can trigger a city's rate.
POSTINGS	Local-ordinance posters and notices refresh after each July cycle — on top of the January statewide set.
THE TRAP	A remote hire in the wrong city quietly puts you on that city's wage schedule — the map redraws itself twice a year.

THE GOOD NEWS

← SEE PAGE 3

The standing watch.

Your managers can run the routine beautifully — and California still rewrites the numbers twice a year. The Compliance Calendar, the January and July resets, and the quarterly reasonable-steps file sit with the CHRO: the standing scope of the retainer on page three. And as the machine earns trust, the CHRO's hours climb into what you build next.

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THE RUNNING MACHINE

What we install, what your managers run — and what *stays with us.*

A retainer that only activates for emergencies is an expensive hotline. This one installs frameworks your managers operate day to day — while the obligations, the resets, and the risk events stay ours to own.

THE FRAMEWORKS WE INSTALL

01
Compliance Calendar
Rolling twelve months of obligations, keyed to month and headcount, each with an owner and a date.

02
Quarterly Refresh
The reasonable-steps file refreshed every quarter — evidence current the day a notice arrives.

03
January & July Resets
Wages, thresholds, statutes: audited, adjusted, notified, documented — as one scheduled motion.

04
Manager Playbooks
Teachable models — Team Building for cohesion, GROW for coaching, Situation-Behavior-Impact for documentation.

05
Escalation Triggers
The bright lines that route risk to HR: harassment, leave or medical, safety — and before any termination.

06
Investigation File
When a risk event lands: FEHA-aligned management — we design, coach, and QA; never conduct.

WHAT YOU WALK AWAY WITH

- **The Owned Calendar** — Nothing recurring depends on anyone's memory — the machine never forgets.
- **Managers Who Run the Routine** — The day-to-day runs in your managers' hands — the risk events stay in ours.
- **The Monthly One-Page Note** — Delivered, decided, prevented — the value visible between the fires.
- **The Current Proof File** — Refreshed quarterly — the documented record ready the day it's needed.

THE HANDOFF
WHERE THE WORK GOES

	TODAY		RUNNING
ROUTINE Qs	YOUR DESK	→	THE MANAGERS
RECURRING	YOUR DESK	→	THE CALENDAR
RISK EVENTS	YOUR DESK	→	THE CHRO

WITH THE MACHINE RUNNING — TWO WAYS

Handing your managers the routine doesn't end the engagement — it redeploys it. The CHRO's hours move to the risk events, the resets, and what you build next.

OPTION A

Steady state
The retainer keeps the machine running — the calendar, the resets, the note, the quarterly refresh. Most clients live here.

THE CORE OF TIER 2 — $3,500/MO · 20 HRS

OPTION B · CHART FORWARD

We climb with you
With the machine earning trust, CHRO work layers on — org design, the executive scoreboard, deal-room support.

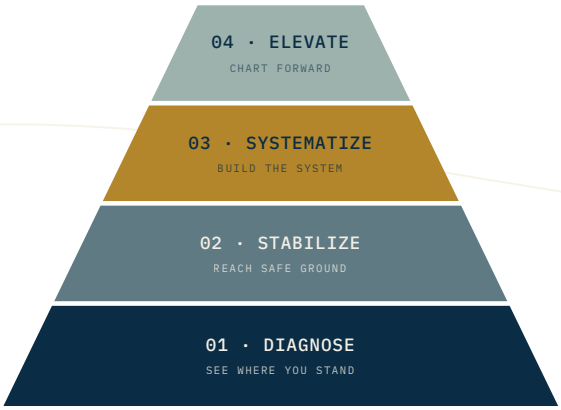
THE CHRO PROJECT · FIXED FEE, SCOPED TO THE WORK

→ *a machine that runs — and proves it ran.*

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A scheduled presence, *not an emergency hotline.*

The California Compass runs in four bearings — diagnose, stabilize, systematize, elevate. Bearing 03 builds the machine: a retainer that only activates for emergencies is an expensive hotline — this one replaces heroics with systems your own managers run.



Every bearing stands on the one below it.

BEARING 03 — SYSTEMATIZE — IS THE CHRO RETAINER

WHAT YOU'RE ACTUALLY BUYING

You're buying installed capability and a retained shield — frameworks your managers run the routine on, while the risk, the reset, and the record stay with us. The difference between every HR question being a fresh fire and routine HR running on rails your own team operates.

- **Your managers stop guessing.**
  Two teachable models and four bright-line escalation triggers.
- **The calendar remembers so you don't.**
  Every obligation keyed to month and headcount, owned and dated.
- **You see the value between the fires.**
  The monthly one-page note: delivered, decided, prevented.

START THE ENGINE

Put routine HR on rails.

You didn't start the company to referee HR questions. With the machine running, your managers handle the routine, the calendar catches the recurring, and the proof file gets fresher every quarter — while you run the business.

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